

37번

The belief that vision is important to driving safely is the reason why measurements of visual capability are an integral part of the test for issuing a driving licence in most countries. Despite these requirements, attempts to find a link between simple visual functions such as visual sharpness and the accident record of drivers have proved largely fruitless. This may be because drivers with worse visual capabilities are aware of their abilities and drive within them. Alternatively, it may be that the visual capabilities measured are too simple. The fact is the drivers' task is a complex one, involving both visual and cognitive factors. Within a very limited time, the driver has to interpret what is likely to happen on the road ahead. To do this, the driver has developed a series of expectations of other drivers' behaviour and of what are the appropriate locations to examine. The driver will be faced with objects of different degrees of visibility and noticeability and will have to make judgements for which the visual system is not always well suited.